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Emily Ching Ma

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Education

Yale University, PhD in Health Policy & Management — New Haven, CT • September 2025– Present

Brown University, 5-year Integrated Undergraduate/Master of Public Health — Providence, RI • May 2023

- Interdisciplinary concentration (Health Equity Studies)
- Delta Omega Honorary Society in Public Health, GPA 4.0
- Master's Thesis: Characterizing Interest in and Uptake of Pre-exposure Prophylaxis (PrEP) for HIV Prevention among Men in a US State Correctional System (Advisors: Dr. Matthew Murphy and Dr. Jasjit Ahluwalia)
- Psychology B.A., Magna Cum Laude, GPA 4.0 — Providence, RI • September 2017– May 2021

University of Cape Town (semester study abroad) — Cape Town, South Africa • July– November, 2019

Publications

Peer reviewed

Published

- Weng X., **Ma E.C.**, Song, et al. (2024). Experiences of quitting smoking in prisons: A qualitative study of people in custody. *Tobacco Induced Diseases*, 22, 10.18332/tid/183604. https://doi.org/10.18332/tid/183604
- **Ma, E.C.**, Rogers B.G., Chan P.A. et al (2024). Characterizing Interest in and Uptake of Preexposure Prophylaxis for HIV Prevention Among Men in a US State Correctional System. *Sexually Transmitted Diseases* 51(3):p 162–170, March 2024. DOI: 10.1097/OLQ.0000000000001912
- Zhou H, Bai G, Gao J, Zhou Y, **Ma E**, et al. (2018). The development of indicator measure for monitoring the quality of patient-centered care in China's tertiary hospitals. *PLOS ONE* 13(10): e0205489. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0205489

Work in progress

- Fu W., **Ma E.C.**, Allore H., Chen X. (2026). Rising Immigration Enforcement Intensity and Nursing Home Care Quality in the US, 2024–2025 [Submitted].
- **Ma E.C.**, Hammoda A., Kwok A., et al. Dying well as a relational capability under unequal conditions: A qualitative study of patients with advanced cancer and family caregivers in Hong Kong.

Policy-reports

- Our Hong Kong Foundation (2022). A Fit-for-Purpose Mental Health System (contributing author).
- Our Hong Kong Foundation (2021). Strategic Purchasing: Enabling Health for All (contributing author).

Awards & Grants

Engaged Scholarship (Undergraduate) Award, Swearer Centre, Brown University — Providence, RI • May 2021

Royce Fellowship 2020-21, Swearer Centre, Brown University — Providence, RI • May 2020– May 2021

SPRINT award ($5,000) for a summer research assistantship, Brown University — May 2019

Research Interests

Immigration | Nursing Home Quality | Long-term Care Workforce

Social Safety Net Programs | Carceral Health

Work Experience

Voyage, Research Associate (Full-time, Evaluation Team) — Hong Kong • August 2023– May 2025

- Assisted Hong Kong University (Professor Michael Wong) and University of Pennsylvania researchers (Professor Maisy Wong, Professor Shing-Yi Wang) in evaluating a longitudinal, large-scale poverty alleviation program (RCT design) adapted to 15 Hong Kong Transitional Housing, sponsored by the Hong Kong Jockey Club Charities Trust
- Supported research participant randomization, survey development and enumerator training
- Managed a data collection firm in collecting data from transitional housing applicants and tenants
- Conducted survey data analysis to inform program implementation, and for monitoring and learning

Our Hong Kong Foundation, Assistant Researcher in Healthcare (FT) Hong Kong • May 2021– June 2022

- Researched barriers to increase Hong Kong's doctor workforce
- Co-authored a research report on health financing and primary healthcare development in Hong Kong
- Co-led primary mixed-methods research on community adult mental healthcare
- Engaged the government and stakeholders for the uptake of policy recommendations

Teaching Experience

Yale School of Public Health, Teaching Fellow New Haven • January– May 2026

- Curated and taught weekly Stata Labs for MPH students in HPM575 Evaluation of Global Health Policies and Programs

Pre-College Programs, Summer@Brown University, Instructor Remote • July 2023, 24, 25

- Designed and taught a 2-week online course for high schoolers on doing global health in low-and-middle income countries, systems thinking tools and critical appraisals of health interventions for two consecutive summers

Brown University, Graduate Teaching Assistant Providence, RI • September–December, 2022

- Facilitated class discussions and graded student papers in a class "Incarceration, Disparities, and Health" enrolling undergraduate and Masters students
- Provided a guest lecture on the phenomenon of "crimmigration" in Hong Kong

Health Demography (Masters level), Lecturer Somaliland • July–August 2022

- Taught a 6-week Demography class for Master of Public Health students at a local university

Community-based Learning & Research Fellow, Fellow Providence, RI • January 2021–May 2021

- Assisted students to conduct health projects with formerly-incarcerated people and local community organizations enrolling undergraduate and masters students

Academic Research

Citizen Action Design Limited (Policy Think Tank), Part-time Researcher Hong Kong • May 2024– June 2025

- Analyzed data from an early childhood e-parenting intervention (RCT) and wrote a manuscript for publication

Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Part-time Research Assistant Hong Kong • July 2023 – May 2024

- Recruited and interviewed end-stage cancer patients and their caregivers in a mixed-methods study on perceptions of "Good Death" and end-of-life care
- Analyzed interviews and drafted manuscripts on "Good Death" from patients and caregivers' perspectives

A Collaborative Research Initiative on Children's Alternative Care, Brown University, Part-time Research Assistant Providence, RI • January–July 2023

- Assisted in conducting a systematic review on the reasons for and the types of family-child separation globally

Miriam Hospital & Warren Alpert Medical School, Research Analyst Providence, RI • Sept. 2022– May 2023

- Conducted a quantitative analysis of men enrolled in a PrEP program for HIV prevention in the Rhode Island Department of Corrections (RIDOC); first-authored a manuscript and prepared presentations

Hong Kong University School of Nursing, Research Volunteer Hong Kong • January–May 2021

- Interviewed participants of a smoking cessation intervention in HK prisons, analyzed data and drafted a manuscript

Psychosocial health promotion for rural youths, Project leader Remote • June 2019– May 2022

- Led IRB and charitable funding applications; conducted community-based participatory action research (Photovoice) to assess the psychosocial needs of low-income and "left-behind" youths in a rural boarding school in Liuchuan, Gansu, China; led teacher capacity building, digital psychosocial health curriculum development and facilitated community sharing sessions with teachers and school administrators

China Center for Agricultural Policy (Peking U), Research Intern Beijing, China • May–July 2019

- Conducted a literature review on the impact of maternal mental health on infants' socio-emotional development
- Researched methodologies to code caregiver-infant dyadic behaviors
- Edited videos on parental training to be shared with parents enrolled in the REAP early childhood development program in rural provinces in China

Early Childhood Investment Initiative (HKUST), Research Intern Hong Kong • June–August 2018

- Conducted quality-checking of online parental questionnaires assessed at midline; administered surveys to parents
- Conducted child developmental assessments (Bayley, Third Edition) in nurseries

- Liaised between parents and program coordinator in a parenting e-learning program to reduce early-life inequities in child development

US-China Health Summit, Research Intern — Beijing, China • March 15–29, 2017

- Translated questionnaires used in China's first nationwide third-party evaluation of tertiary hospitals; drafted a manuscript on developing quality indicators of medical care in tertiary hospitals and a Sichuan case study of Healthy China 2030

Conferences & Presentations

- **Ma, E.,** Rogers, B., Ahluwalia, J.S., Toma, E., Murphy, M. (2023, June 6). Characterizing Interest in and Uptake of Pre-exposure Prophylaxis (PrEP) for HIV Prevention among Men in a US State Correctional System [Poster presentation]. Department of Medicine Annual Research Forum. Alpert Medical School of Brown University, Providence, RI, United States.
- **Ma, E.,** Ao, L., Guo, H., et al. (2023, April 24). A qualitative study assessing the barriers and facilitators to psychosocial wellbeing among youths in rural China [Poster presentation]. Global Health Research Day. Warren Alpert Medical School of Brown University, Providence, RI, United States.
- **Ma, E.,** Rogers, B., Ahluwalia, J.S., Toma, E., Murphy, M. (2023, April 4). Characterizing Interest in and Uptake of Pre-exposure Prophylaxis (PrEP) for HIV Prevention among Men in a US State Correctional System [Poster presentation]. Public Health Research Day. Brown University, Providence, RI, United States.
- **Ma, E.** & Ao, L. (2021, February 17). Findings and lessons from community-based participatory action research and implementing psychosocial health interventions for youths in Gansu, China [Royce Fellowship Final presentation]. Virtual.

Languages & Skills

Languages: Fluent in English, Mandarin, and Cantonese

Technical skills: Proficient: R, STATA, Python, Qualtrics, NVivo, MAXQDA24, Mendeley Reference Manager, Zotero; Basic: EndNote, ArcGIS, Abstrackr, Google Earth Engine

Community Engagement

HAVEN free clinic, Education Department — New Haven • June 2026 to present

- Providing lifestyle counselling to predominantly uninsured and low-income patients at the free clinic on Saturday

Grant-application support for NGOs — Hong Kong • September–December 2023

- Beat Drugs Fund 2023 ($206,000 awarded to MercyHK) from the Hong Kong Narcotics Division, March 2024
- Beat Drugs Fund 2020 ($85,000 awarded to Voice for Prisoners) from the Hong Kong Narcotics Division, February 2021

Refugee Youth Tutoring — Providence, RI • November 2017– May 2019, January–June 2023

- Tutoring recently-resettled Kurdish refugees in the home setting weekly

Voice for Prisoners, former Volunteer Coordinator, now volunteer in Prison Visitation — Hong Kong • May 2020– present

- Applied for and secured a government grant to support an anti-drug-trafficking campaign; coordinated volunteers to participate in prison visitation and letter-writing, provided social and legal assistance, promoted access to education

Hong Kong Dignity Institute (NGO), Mental Health Intern — Hong Kong • September– December 2020

- Conducted an internal evaluation of services provided to asylum-seekers, migrant workers, and trafficking victims

MercyHK, NGO Alliance for the Homeless, Volunteer — Hong Kong • September 2020– May 2022

- Interviewed homeless individuals and produced videos for policy advocacy; developed and administered a questionnaire across alliance NGOs to identify service gaps for service improvement

Project Change (Citizen Action Design Limited), Social Media Intern — Hong Kong • May–August, 2020

- Developed the website and social media campaigns on Facebook, Instagram and Telegram for the counseling and legal support program for incarcerated youths and their families involved in the anti-extradition bill movement

Other Publications

Ma, E. (2021). The Policing of Cross-Border Goods, Bodies, and Births: Deconstructing the "gendered prison crisis" in Hong Kong. Brown Undergraduate Journal of Public Health.

Opinion articles

- **Ma, E.,** & Wang, S. (2022, March 24). Allowing prisoners to call loved ones during ban on visits is essential for their well-being. South China Morning Post – Letters
- **Ma, E.** (2022, March 13). More beds for Covid-19 patients, but with a shortage of nurses, who will care for them? South China Morning Post – Letters
- Qamar, M. & **Ma, E.** (2022, March 1). Hong Kong could study Singapore and mainland examples on home vaccination for the elderly. South China Morning Post – Letters
- Wong, S. & **Ma, E.** (2022, February 27). Health, social vulnerabilities should be considered in isolation-facility admission. China Daily.
- **Ma, E.** (2022, February 18). As Hong Kong fights Covid-19, volunteers can play a crucial role. South China Morning Post – Letters
- Tin, P. & **Ma, E.** (2022, February 5). To improve Hong Kong's primary health care, get Hongkongers involved. South China Morning Post – Opinion.
- Tin, P. & **Ma, E.** (2021, September 3). How the Chinese Medicine Hospital can Strengthen TCM integration in Hong Kong public health care. South China Morning Post – Opinion.